

## Prahl Portfolio Work Log - July 24, 2026

Compiled summary for Friday, July 24, 2026 - focus: continued Prahl.dev Portfolio landing-page refinement after the July 23 case-study pass, including Instagram CTA replacement, responsive top navigation restructuring, Prahl.dev brand-card spacing, dedicated Articles page creation, UI/UX Philosophy card expansion, long-copy collapse behavior, article-page scroll fixes, Visual/Textual Balance copy cleanup, Cinerific hero tablet artwork insertion, image rotation/scale/position tuning, refreshed project snapshot context, successful validation checks, review of all prior Portfolio PDF worklogs, and generation of the daily Portfolio PDF worklog.

Generated in continuity with the established Prahl Portfolio daily worklog cadence: compact opening summary, source-material section, baseline section, goal list, work-completed sections, validation section, files-touched list, follow-up context, and output-artifact close.

This artifact intentionally covers only Prahl Portfolio work performed during the July 24 local project session: the refreshed project snapshot, review of every pre-existing Portfolio worklog PDF, the landing-page/navigation work represented by commits 90fd5a9 and 2cee18b, the Articles/UIUX/Hero tablet work represented by commit 6cefb6, local validation checks, development-cache resets, route checks, headless Chrome layout measurement, and this worklog-generation step. Alla Vostra, Cinerific, and Credit King application repositories were not changed for this record.

### Source Materials Reviewed

- Ran `./read_project.sh` from `/Users/prahlin/gh/portfolio` and regenerated `portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt` before writing this worklog, preserving the project convention that Codex refreshes the current source snapshot before continuing Portfolio work.
- Reviewed the refreshed `portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt`, including the current source tree, app source dumps, root/tooling/deployment configuration, public image inventory, PDF inventory, git context, and the standing instruction to ask for a commit message before committing or pushing.
- Reviewed every pre-existing Portfolio root-level worklog PDF: `portfolio_worklog_july11.pdf`, `portfolio_worklog_july14.pdf`, `portfolio_worklog_july15_part1.pdf`, `portfolio_worklog_july15_part2.pdf`, `portfolio_worklog_july16.pdf`, `portfolio_worklog_july19.pdf`, `portfolio_worklog_july20.pdf`, `portfolio_worklog_july21.pdf`, `portfolio_worklog_july22.pdf`, and `portfolio_worklog_july23.pdf`.
- Extracted text from all ten existing Portfolio PDFs with `pdftotext` to preserve the same title cadence, opening summary density, section order, compact bullet-heavy technical voice, validation language, files-touched list, follow-up context, and output-artifact close.
- Used `portfolio_worklog_july23.pdf` as the closest same-project reference because it already documented late-stage responsive landing-card work, nav copy changes, user-directed visual iteration, public synchronization, local tool additions, and the current root-level PDF naming convention.
- Checked PDF metadata with `pdftinfo` and confirmed mature Portfolio artifacts use letter-size pages, Helvetica/Helvetica-Bold base fonts, six-page compact bodies, root-level filenames, and Codex standard-library PDF-generator metadata.
- Reviewed July 24 Git history through `git log`, `git show --stat`, `git show --name-status`, targeted source inspection, and the final HEAD/origin/main match at 6cefb6.
- Reviewed the committed source scopes for 90fd5a9, 2cee18b, and 6cefb6, covering Instagram CTA changes, top-nav restructuring, shared PortfolioSections extraction, Articles page creation, UI/UX Philosophy card data, ExpandablePrincipleCopy behavior, and Cinerific promo asset insertion.
- Reviewed `app/page.tsx`, `app/PortfolioSections.tsx`, `app/ExpandablePrincipleCopy.tsx`, `app/articles/page.tsx`, `app/globals.css`, `public/images/cinerific_promo.png`, `package.json`, `read_project.sh`, and the refreshed project snapshot.
- Checked local route responses for `http://localhost:3000/` and `http://localhost:3000/articles` during the July 24 session after clearing stale development cache output.
- Ran headless Chrome layout measurement against `/articles` after the scroll-tail bug was fixed, confirming document height ended at the final card/grid bottom rather than invisible measurement-text overflow.

## Baseline Status Before July 24 Work

- The July 23 Portfolio site already had the Prahlin.dev brand, stable Full Stack / RN / Kotlin / Mobile Developer headline wrapping, four case-study cards with project-title/device-stack styling, corrected visible commit/worklog counts, Stack section two-column protection, and proof-stat label synchronization.
- The top navigation still carried the previous link ordering and emphasis model. Worklog, Stack, Case Studies, Articles, About Dev, and Contact still needed several user-directed passes to achieve the desired two-row card distribution, separator placement, active-link behavior, and final Articles hiding behavior.
- The social CTA row still used the Dribbble treatment and basketball-style icon before the user clarified that Dribbble should become Instagram, using the official-looking Instagram color treatment and matching icon-box sizing.
- The Prahlin.dev brand card inside the top nav had become highly sensitive to responsive two-row layout changes, especially where the P mark, Prahlin.dev wordmark, border box, parent nav-card edges, row heights, and separators needed to remain visually stable across window aspect ratios.
- There was no dedicated /articles route at the beginning of the work. The Articles nav text existed, but the requested page needed to be made actionable and populated with an exact copy of the landing-page Featured Case Studies section before being transformed into a UI/UX Philosophy article index.
- The Articles page had not yet received the From UI To 'You-I' title, 12 Philosophical Principles subtitle, Principle cards, long description text, card duplication/expansion behavior, or later UI/UX Philosophy text replacements.
- Long UI/UX philosophy descriptions did not yet have the requested eight-visible-line default collapse rule, read-more expansion behavior, full-row expansion behavior, or no-empty-cell grid ordering protection.
- The landing page hero tablet still displayed the older Cinerific intro artwork before the later hero-tablet pass, and the user wanted the Cinerific promo artwork inserted, scaled, rotated, and nudged inside the landscape tablet frame without disturbing the frame itself.
- The project workflow remained local-first unless the user explicitly requested a commit, push, deployment, or public update. Commit-message recommendations continued using the requested one-header plus hyphen-bullet style.

## Goals for July 24

- Replace the Dribbble social CTA with an Instagram button using #E1306C for button fill and icon fill, while preserving button dimensions, icon-box sizing, and hero social-row proportions.
- Rebuild the landing-page top nav so Prahlin.dev, Articles or Worklog, Stack, Case Studies, and the remaining links distribute responsively according to the user visual feedback, especially in two-row states.
- Preserve the P mark aspect ratio, Prahlin.dev font treatment, brand-card border, parent nav-card height, parent/card edge alignment, and two-row height invariants while tuning separators and row spacing.
- Create a dedicated /articles page that contains only the global top nav followed directly by the Featured Case Studies section copied from the landing page, then transform that section into the UI/UX Philosophy article-card grid.
- Populate the UI/UX Philosophy section with repeated cards, principle titles, random placeholder text where requested, and then progressively replace card descriptions with the user supplied white-text article snippets.
- Enforce the rule that any UI/UX Philosophy white-text copy exceeding eight rendered lines defaults to an eight-line preview followed by . . . [read more].
- Let expanded long-copy cards occupy the full current grid row width in multi-column layouts, while avoiding empty grid cells by reordering cards that would otherwise leave gaps before an expanded card.
- Remove device-frame stacks, chip stacks, and unintended landing-page side effects from the Articles/UIUX work, keeping landing-page case-study visuals restored where the user rejected accidental changes.
- Fix Articles page scroll behavior so the page has a single outer browser scrollbar, no massive

- hidden blank tail, and only one row-gap worth of breathing room after the final UI/UX card.
- Insert Cinerific into the landing hero tablet frame with preserved aspect ratio, then tune the inner image rotation, scaling, and position without changing the tablet-frame rotation.

### **Work Completed - Instagram CTA and Responsive Top Navigation**

- Replaced the Dribbble social button with an Instagram button and moved the visual treatment to the user-requested #E1306C fill color.
- Replaced the previous basketball-style icon treatment with an Instagram icon sized to match the surrounding social icon box expectations.
- Tuned the Instagram text-to-icon horizontal gap repeatedly after user feedback, including corrections where earlier vertical-gap adjustments targeted the wrong axis.
- Reworked the top nav card into the requested responsive two-row behavior, with PrahL.dev and the first-row links distributed separately from the bottom-row links.
- Expanded nav copy to Case Studies, Stack, Worklog, Experience, Articles, About, and Contact before later removing Experience and renaming About to About Dev.
- Reduced link font sizing and adjusted row gaps so the top card did not create unintended third-row wrapping under compressed widths.
- Added separator pipe characters between link assets and then repeatedly corrected their placement so the PrahL.dev/P mark stack was treated as a full nav asset rather than an inherited left-aligned exception.
- Broke the older PrahL.dev/P-box alignment assumptions inherited from the original landing page so the brand stack could participate in the new responsive top-row distribution.
- Added the thin bordered brand box around the P mark and PrahL.dev wordmark, matched its border, radius, color, and visibility to the parent nav card, and later removed internal padding where requested.
- Protected the P mark aspect ratio during window resizing and kept the PrahL.dev box/card height relationship stable across two-row layouts.
- Swapped Worklog and Articles globally in the shared nav data, then added context-aware active nav styling so only the currently opened page receives the bold active weight.
- Preserved the PrahL.dev brand link as an exception: it never receives the active-page font-weight class and keeps its established brand font treatment.
- Made the Articles nav link visually invisible through opacity: 0 while preserving its spacing and click target, per the final top-nav instruction.

### **Work Completed - Shared PortfolioSections Extraction and Articles Page**

- Moved reusable navigation and featured case-study rendering into app/PortfolioSections.tsx so the landing page and Articles page share the same nav/card source of truth.
- Kept app/page.tsx focused on the landing hero, stack, worklog, and contact sections after removing the now-shared case-study and nav implementation from the landing page file.
- Added app/articles/page.tsx as a dedicated Articles route that renders the shared MainNavBar and the shared FeaturedCaseStudies component in articlesMode.
- Made the landing-page Articles link actionable by pointing the shared nav item to /articles in both home and non-home contexts.
- Started the Articles page with a copy of the Featured Case Studies section, then changed its heading to UI/UX Philosophy and its title to From UI To 'You-I': with the requested 12 Philosophical Principles subtitle.
- Preserved the landing-page Featured Case Studies section after user correction by scoping Articles-specific content, title replacement, and UI/UX card behavior to articlesMode.
- Duplicated the four case-study cards to form twelve opening UI/UX philosophy cards, then changed green eyebrow text to Principle without confusing number-order artifacts.
- Replaced initial card titles with Focus, Dehumanization, Contrast, Grounding, Visual/Textual, Anthropomorphization, Pos Space, Emotional Conveyence, Working Around, More Is More, Less Is More, and Progress.
- Added the screenshot-derived hash-title principle cards after reading the user provided Adobe Portfolio screenshot and extracting only items with a leading hash symbol.
- Removed device-frame/platform stacks from UI/UX Philosophy cards and later removed chip/stat stacks from article-mode reused case-study cards, keeping the landing-page case-study cards

intact.

- Matched article subtitle color, font inheritance, style, and weight to the landing-page lede while preserving its current size.
- Replaced or inserted many white-text description bodies from user-provided material, including BE PERSISTENT, BE RESILIENT, BE OVERZELOUS, BE ENTERTAINING, BE BORING, BE CONCISE, BE VICARIOUS, BE FLEXIBLE, BE CHOOSY, BE SCALABLE, BE WISE, BE IMPERSONAL, BE FOCUSED, BE EMOTIONAL, BE HUMAN, MORE IS MORE, VISUAL-TEXTUAL BALANCE, and BE COMMUNICATIVE.

### **Work Completed - Long-Copy Collapse, Expansion, and Article Layout Fixes**

- Added app/ExpandablePrincipleCopy.tsx as the client component responsible for long UI/UX Philosophy card copy, eight-line previews, read-more toggles, and expanded-card grid ordering.
- Replaced the first paragraph-count collapse rule with rendered-height measurement so cards with a small number of long wrapped paragraphs still collapse when the white text exceeds eight visual lines.
- Added a hidden same-width measuring node that uses the same typography, line height, wrapping, and white-space behavior as the visible preview text.
- Fixed the measurement node after it created a giant hidden scroll tail by setting its height and max-height to zero while preserving scrollHeight for the measurement calculation.
- Confirmed with headless Chrome that the Articles document height dropped from the invisible 11650px overflow state back to the actual final grid/card bottom.
- Made long cards default to the collapsed eight-line preview when the measured copy needs nine or more visual lines, regardless of paragraph breaks or the current column count.
- Added . . . [read more] immediately after the collapsed preview and let the clicked/tapped card expand into full copy.
- Changed expanded-card behavior so multi-column layouts use full-row width instead of only growing downward, while one-column portrait layouts naturally expand vertically.
- Added grid-order reconciliation so cards before an expanded item can move after it when needed, preventing one or more empty card cells from appearing in the UI/UX Philosophy grid.
- Removed the Articles page inner scroll-container behavior by changing the page wrapper from overflow-x: hidden to overflow-x: clip, restoring the single outer browser scrollbar.
- Removed the massive blank vertical whitespace below the UI/UX Philosophy section and then restored exactly one 18px grid-row gap below the final card for visually consistent breathing room.
- Kept these fixes scoped to .articles-page, .uiux-principle-card, and articlesMode so the landing page case-study cards and project routes were not changed unintentionally.

### **Work Completed - Landing Hero Cinerific Tablet Preview**

- Swapped the hero tablet preview image source from the older Cinerific intro frame to public/images/cinerific\_promo.png, the landscape promo artwork that better fills the tablet frame.
- Added the Cinerific promo asset to public/images and verified its 1000 x 625 landscape dimensions before using it in the hero tablet.
- Put the decorative tablet grid behind the image by assigning z-index values so the Cinerific artwork becomes the actual visible screen content.
- Changed tablet image fit behavior several times based on user feedback, moving from contain, to cover, back to contain, and finally to a rotated/scaled image treatment that preserves aspect ratio while allowing clipped overflow inside the screen.
- Preserved the original tablet frame rotation at rotate(-5deg) scale(1.5) after the user rejected rotating the full frame more aggressively.
- Rotated only the Cinerific image inside the tablet to the final requested clockwise angle after several two-degree and eight-degree adjustment passes.
- Scaled the rotated image dramatically so the tablet viewing area is filled while the tablet screen overflow hides image portions outside the frame.
- Nudged the inner image down and right, then reduced the down offset slightly, so the Cinerific letters, googly eyes, and eyebrows remain visible inside the tablet screen.

### **Validation and Checks Performed**

- Ran npm run check repeatedly during the July 24 session and confirmed TypeScript validation passed with tsc --noEmit after the Articles/UIUX, nav, scroll, and hero tablet changes.
- Used curl -I against http://localhost:3000/ and http://localhost:3000/articles to confirm both local routes returned 200 OK after cache resets and route additions.
- Cleared the Next.js development cache several times by stopping port 3000 listeners, moving .next/dev aside, and restarting npm run dev when Chrome showed stale output.
- Verified /articles HTML contained the expected Articles heading, UI/UX title text, active-nav class, and newly inserted user-provided text snippets during the copy-replacement passes.
- Verified the home page did not inherit article-only UI/UX body text where the user specifically asked to restore the landing-page case-study section.
- Used source searches to confirm the old nav emphasis label set was removed and replaced by the page-context active link class.
- Used headless Chrome and Chrome DevTools Protocol layout metrics to diagnose the Articles page scroll-tail bug and confirm hidden measurement text no longer extended scrollHeight after the CSS fix.
- Used sips and file checks to confirm the Cinerific hero tablet image dimensions and file type before replacing the image source.
- Used git show --stat, git show --name-status, and git log to confirm the July 24 implementation scope represented by commits 90fd5a9, 2cee18b, and 6cefb6.
- Regenerated portfolio\_PROJECT\_SNAPSHOT.txt before this PDF so the current source tree, recent commits, image inventory, PDF inventory, and project context were represented locally.
- Generated this PDF with the same standard-library PDF writer style used by the mature Portfolio worklogs and checked metadata/text extraction after writing.

### Files Touched During July 24 Portfolio Work

- app/page.tsx - removed duplicated nav/case-study implementation in favor of shared PortfolioSections usage, kept landing-specific hero content, wired the Cinerific promo into the tablet preview, and preserved the rest of the landing page sections.
- app/PortfolioSections.tsx - added the shared nav, SectionHeading, FeaturedCaseStudies, CaseStudyCard, HashPrincipleCard, article-mode data, UI/UX Philosophy titles, body-copy constants, nav ordering, Articles link, and active-page nav behavior.
- app/ExpandablePrincipleCopy.tsx - added measured eight-line copy collapse, read-more expansion, expanded-card class toggling, resize syncing, and grid-order reconciliation for no-empty-cell expanded-card layouts.
- app/articles/page.tsx - added the dedicated Articles route with shared top nav and article-mode FeaturedCaseStudies section using the From UI To 'You-I' heading system.
- app/globals.css - tuned Instagram/social styling, nav layout, brand box alignment, active/invisible Articles link behavior, Articles page spacing, article subtitle styling, UI/UX card typography, long-copy preview/measure behavior, expanded-card columns, scroll fixes, and hero tablet image fit/rotation/positioning.
- public/images/cinerific\_promo.png - added the Cinerific promo artwork used inside the landing hero tablet frame.
- portfolio\_PROJECT\_SNAPSHOT.txt - regenerated by ./read\_project.sh for this worklog pass and left modified locally as a project-context artifact.
- portfolio\_worklog\_july24.pdf - generated as this daily Portfolio worklog artifact in the root-level Portfolio worklog convention.

### Follow-Up Context

- The public website source is already represented by origin/main at 6cefb6, and the July 24 source commits have been pushed to the main branch.
- The refreshed portfolio\_PROJECT\_SNAPSHOT.txt and this July 24 PDF remain local until the user provides or approves a commit message for documentation artifact changes.
- Because this PDF increases the Portfolio worklog count from 10 to 11, the visible Prahlin.dev card worklog count can be updated later if the user wants the public site to reflect this new artifact.
- The Articles link is intentionally invisible through opacity: 0 while preserving its layout space and click target. Future nav work should not assume it was removed from the DOM.

- The Prahlin.dev brand item remains protected from active-link font-weight changes; only the currently opened non-brand page should receive active styling.
- Future Articles/UIUX copy replacement should continue editing only the relevant bodyParagraphs constant in app/PortfolioSections.tsx and should not alter landing-page case-study copy unless explicitly requested.
- The hidden UI/UX measurement paragraph must keep height: 0, max-height: 0, and overflow: hidden so it can measure scrollHeight without creating browser-scroll overflow.
- Expanded UI/UX cards use grid-order manipulation to prevent empty cells. If the grid structure changes later, retest expansion in three-column, two-column, and one-column layouts.
- The Cinerific hero tablet currently relies on image-only transform tuning inside the original rotated tablet frame. Future edits should distinguish between frame rotation and inner-image rotation before changing either.
- Continue treating all future Portfolio work as local-only unless the user explicitly asks to commit, push, deploy, publish, or update the public website.

### **Output Artifact**

- Generated file: portfolio\_worklog\_july24.pdf.
- Location: /Users/prahlin/gh/portfolio/portfolio\_worklog\_july24.pdf.
- Naming follows the existing root-level Portfolio convention: portfolio\_worklog\_july24.pdf. No part suffix was used because this is the first July 24 Portfolio worklog artifact.
- Uses the same daily worklog structure and compact technical voice established by portfolio\_worklog\_july11.pdf through portfolio\_worklog\_july23.pdf.
- Generated with a small standard-library PDF writer; no external PDF dependency was installed for this artifact.
- The local project date used for this filename and title is Friday, July 24, 2026 EDT, matching the machine and repository work session clock.